108. National Agricultural Insurance Scheme replacing Comprehensive Crop Insurance Scheme was introduced in the year:

(a) 1997 (b) 1998
(c) 1999 (d) 2000

Ans. (c) : The first crop insurance scheme in the country was run as a test from 1973 to 1984. The Union Agriculture Ministry started Comprehensive Crop Insurance Scheme from April 1985.

In place of this, a 'National Agricultural Insurance Scheme: 1999-2000' has been implemented from Rabi year 1999-2000.

The main objective of this scheme is to protect the farmers from crop damage due to natural calamities like drought, flood, hailstorm, cyclone, fire, pests, diseases, so that their credit rating can be restored in the coming season.

109. Consider the following states:

1. Gujarat 2. Karnataka
3. Maharashtra 4. Tamil Nadu

The descending order of these states with reference to their level of Per Capita Net State Domestic Product is:

(a) 1, 3, 4, 2 (b) 3, 1, 2, 4
(c) 1, 3, 2, 4 (d) 3, 1, 4, 2

Ans. (d) : Net State Domestic Product Per Capita at current prices in descending order Goa, Chandigarh, Punjab, Haryana, Maharashtra, Gujarat, Tamil Nadu, Karnataka.

110. The range of Agni-II missile is around:

(a) 500 km (b) 2000 km
(c) 3500 km (d) 5000 km

Ans. (b) : Range of Agni II missile is around 2000 km. This air-to-air ballistic missile is based on indigenous technology.

SLV-4 rockets are used in Agni missiles. India is one of the 6 superpowers that has developed the medium-range missile capability.

Agni-I – 1500Km
Agni-II – 2000-2500Km
Agni-III– 3000-3500Km
Agni-IV– 4000Km
Agni V – 5000 Km

111. Consider the following schemes launched by the Union Government:

1. Antyodaya Anna Yojana
2. Gram Sadak Yojana
3. Sarvapriya
4. Jawahar Gram Samridhi Yojana

Which of the above were announced in the year 2000?

(a) 1 and 2 (b) 2 and 4
(c) 3 and 4 (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans. (d) : Antyoday Anna Yojna is a sponsored scheme of government of India to provide highly subsidised food to poor families. It was launched in December, 2000.

Pradhanmantri Gram Sadak Yojna is a nationwide plan to provide all weather road connectivity to unconnected villages. It was also launched in year 2000.

Sarvapriya Yojna - 2002 – by consumer affairs, food and publi distribution ministry.

Jawahar Gram Samridhi Yojna - April, 1999.

112. A great Landslide caused by an earthquake killed hundreds of people in January 2001 near:

(a) San salvador (b) San Jose
(c) Mangula (d) Guatemala City

Ans. (a) : Hundreds of people were killed near San Salvador (EI Salvador) due to landslide caused by an earthquake measuring (7.7 to 7.9) on Richter scale in year 2001.

113. Falun Gong is:

(a) An ethnic minority in Eastern China
(b) An insurgency outfit in Western China
(c) A pro-democracy movement in China
(d) A spiritual movement in China

Ans. (d) : Falun Gong or Falun Dafa is a Chinese religious spiritual practice that combines meditation and qigong exercises with a moral philosophy centered on the tenets of truthfulness, compassion, and forbearance. Through moral rectitude and the practice of meditation, practitioners of Falun Gong aspire to eliminate attachments, and ultimately to achieve spiritual enlightenment. Falun Gong originated and was first taught publicly in northeastern China in 1992 by Li Hongzhi.

114. Who is the scientist in whose honour the "Chandra" X-ray telescope has been named?

(a) Chandrasekhar Venkat Raman
(b) Jagdish Chandra Bose
(c) Prafulla Chandra Roy
(d) Subramanyam Chandrasekhar

Ans. (d) : "Chandra" X-ray telescope has been named after famous physicist of Indian origin Subramanyam Chandrasekhar.

115. The Union Budget 2000 awarded a Tax Holiday for the North-Eastern Region to promote industrialisation for:

(a) 5 years (b) 7 years
(c) 9 years (d) 10 years

Ans. (d) : The then Finance Minister Yashwant Sinha, while presenting the budget of 1999-2000, made provision for tax holiday for 10 years to provide industrialization incentives in the Northeast region.

116. Match List I with List II and select the correct answer using the codes given below the lists:

	List I (Award/Prize)		List II (Recipient)
A.	Indira Gandhi Prize for Peace, Disarmament and Development	1.	Archibiship Desmond Tutu
B.	Jamnalal Bajaj Award	2.	Dr. Gurudev Singh Kush
C.	International Gandhi Peace Prize	3.	Dr. M.S. Swaminathan
D.	World Food Prize	4.	Nelson Mandela

	A	B	C	D
(a)	1	3	4	2
(b)	3	1	4	2
(c)	1	3	2	4
(d)	3	1	2	4

Ans. (b) : 1. Indira Gandhi Prize for Peace, Disarmament and Development – Dr. M.S. Swaminathan
2. Jamnalal Bajaj Award – Archibiship Desmond Tutu
3. International Gandhi Peace Prize – Nelson Mandela
4. World Food Prize – Dr. Gurudev Singh Kush

117. Which among the following ports was called Babul Makka (Gate of Makka) during the Mughal Period?

(a) Calicut (b) Borach
(c) Cambay (d) Surat

Ans. (d) : Surat had an important place as a port in Mughal economic activities. This port was called the Mecca Gate because Muslims used to go for the pilgrimage from this port.

118. The Chess player Alexi Shirov represents:

(a) Albania (b) Kazhakstan
(c) Russia (d) Spain

Ans. (d) : The chess player Alexi Shirov represents spain. He was ranked 2nd in the World in 1994.

119. The theme of the World Development Report 2001, is:

(a) From Plan to market
(b) Knowledge for Development
(c) Attacking Poverty
(d) The State in the Changing world

Ans. (c) : "Attacking Poverty" was the theme of the World Development Report 2001.

The World Bank has published the World Development Report 2021: Data for Better Lives.

120. Mekong Ganga co-operation project is:

(a) An irrigation project involving India and Myanmar
(b) A joint tourism initiative of some Asian countries
(c) A hydroelectric power project involving India, Bangladesh and Myanmar
(d) A defence and security agreement of India with its eastern neighbours

Ans. (b) : Mekong Ganga Co-operation Project is a joint tourism initiative of some Asian countries. It comprises six member countries, namely India (Look-East connectivity projects), Thailand, Myanmar, Cambodia, Laos and Vietnam. The four areas of cooperation are tourism, culture, education, and transportation. The organization takes its name from the Ganga and the Mekong, two large rivers in the region.

121. Who amongest the following was the Chairman of I.S.R.O. when INSAT-3B was launched?

(a) Anil Kakodkar (b) Abdul Kalam
(c) K. Kasturirangn (d) U.R. Rao

Ans. (c) : K. Kasturirangan was the chairman of I.S.R.O when INSAT-3B was launched.

Directions : The following 12 (twelve) items consist of two statements, one labelled as the 'Assertion (A)' and the other as 'Reason (R). You are to examine these two statements carefully and select the answer to these items using the code given below:

(a) Both A and R are individually true and R is the correct explanation of A
(b) Both A and R are individually true but R is NOT the correct explanation of A
(c) A is true but R is false
(d) A is false but R is true

122. Assertion (A) : India's software exports increased at an average growth rate of 50% since 1995-96.
Reason (R) : Indian software companies were cost-effective and maintained international quality.

(a) Both A and R are individually true and R is the correct explanation of A
(b) Both A and R are individually true but R is NOT the correct explanation of A
(c) A is true but R is false
(d) A is false but R is true

Ans. (a) : The impact of the 1991 economic reforms ranged from the service sector to the information technology sector. The Indian software industry is also growing with a rapid export rate of around 60%. The reason for this is the quality at the international level as well as the low price, which is the general rule of the economy.